sufficient to make rockets.'

'You mean drawings are useless? Then why do you have them?'

'No, I said they are not sufficient. In the development of a rocket or an engine, drawings are but a minor part. Conceptual drawings are available in textbooks and journals. Nobody will pay money to buy them.'

At this point, the second man asked a few questions which made me think that he was interested in knowing about the technology—and perhaps the truth.

* * *

I asked for Siby Mathews. They wanted to know why I need to meet him. I told them that I had heard of Siby Mathews as the police officer who handled a mark list case in Kerala, and that I felt he was an upright officer.

'I can convince him of my innocence,' I said.

They said it was Siby who is convinced of my involvement in the ISRO spy case. When I insisted on meeting them, they left the room. Soon, the first set of officers came back. One of them lit another Panama cigarette and offered me a smoke. I took one, lit it and inhaled deep. The interrogation resumed.

'Your subordinate Sasi has told us that you all met at Hotel Madras International on 24 January 1994 to finalise the deal. Now tell me what the deal was,' he said.

'I don't know of any deal.'

'Where were you on 24 January 1994?'

'I don't remember.'

'You try, you will remember. You cannot forget that day so easily. When your subordinate Sasi remembers everything so vividly, how can you forget? You are known for your memory power.'

I was getting irritated.

'Can you please tell me where you were last Friday?' I shot back.

The prime interrogator was now furious. 'Don't ask me questions. Just answer mine.'